

MAGSMEN

STRATEGY CONSULTANTS

Sorvet

Gen Z Category & Positioning Analysis — Hyderabad

Prepared for Sorvet · Pramukh Industries, Tirupati

Hyderabad's Gen Z Ice Cream Landscape

Hyderabad Gen Z Geography

- Concentrated in Jubilee Hills / Banjara Hills (affluent), Madhapur / Gachibowli / Hi-Tech City (tech-adjacent students & young professionals), spreading into Kondapur / Manikonda / Miyapur.
- Near-universal smartphone + UPI access. Discovery happens on Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, and the Zomato/Swiggy feed — not physical footfall or word-of-mouth alone.

Dining-Out & Dessert Trends

- Dessert and ice cream parlours are among the fastest-growing segments in India's organised food services; new spots open in the Jubilee Hills / Banjara Hills corridor every quarter.
- Gen Z dine-out transactions on Swiggy Dineout grew 96.8% YoY (2024–25). Hyderabad, as a Tier-1 tech city, mirrors this behaviour.

The 'Dual Appetite'

Hyderabad's Gen Z runs on two separate, non-overlapping ice cream occasions — not one spectrum.

Kirana / convenience ice cream

Impulse, hot-day, affordable.

Premium destination dessert

Experience, social currency, weekend outing.

IMPLICATION: A brand has to choose which occasion it's fighting for. Trying to serve both without picking a lane is itself a strategic error.

Food as a Vehicle for Self-Expression

The 'Third Space'

Cafés and dessert parlours function as Gen Z's 'third space' — outside home and college/work — used for social proof, identity display, and out-of-home entertainment. 43% of India's total retail entertainment spend is Gen Z.

Food as Self-Expression

Food is a top-3 Gen Z identity attribute, ranked after music and gaming (Sodexo Insights). 4 in 5 Gen Z see food as self-expression, not just sustenance. 63% rank social commerce as important to their shopping experience; 57% rank livestreaming as important (KPMG India, 2024).

The Fashion–Food Transfer

Fashion and food run on the same underlying driver: identity construction and social signalling. A consumer's fashion 'core' predicts their food choice — Old Money / Quiet Luxury favours understated premium gelato; Y2K / Maximalist favours pastel, playful, photogenic packaging.

PROOF POINT: Milano's flower-shaped gelato (₹300, viral May 2026) went viral for how it looks, not how it tastes — designed to be photographed first, tasted second.

Where the Brand Stands Today

- Manufactured by Pramukh Industries (Tirupati, AP); sold as Cones, Luxury Sticks, and Family Tubs.
- 15 flavours sit comfortably in the premium-artisanal bracket — Madagascar Chocolate, Death By Chocolate, Tiramisu, Swiss Milk Chocolate — internationally-coded, story-ready names.
- Distributed only through kirana/general stores in Balaji Nagar, Shahid Nagar, and Manikonda — middle-income residential pockets — with zero parlour, zero Q-commerce presence, and zero social content strategy.

POSITION

An artisan-aspirant brand riding a mass-distribution model with no digital identity. Not premium enough to command the Milano crowd; not visible enough to beat Kwaliti Walls at the kirana shelf.

4 · FOUR DIAGNOSED FAILURE POINTS

Where the Brand Is Losing Ground



Naming / Category Confusion

'Sorvet' reads like 'sorbet'; possible first-impression mismatch.



Physical Distribution Findability

Every stockist address is a private residence, not a shop name.



Digital / Q-Commerce Absence

Zero Blinkit / Zepto / Instamart listing.



Packaging & Social Content Gap

No unboxing / first-bite content strategy despite a photogenic format.

A. Naming Confusion · B. Distribution Findability

A. Naming / Category Confusion

Sorbet is a well-known dessert category to most of Gen Z — a non-dairy, fruit-based ice, historically traced through Persian sharbat traditions into Sicilian and Italian sorbetto. 'Sorvet' sits one letter away from that word.

The working hypothesis: a Gen Z viewer's first impression on seeing a Sorvet Reel is 'sorbet' — and the moment they register it's milk-based, curiosity tips into doubt before purchase intent has a chance to form.

However this is not verified.

B. Physical Distribution Findability

Confirmed directly on sorvet.in: every listed stockist address is a house or flat number in a residential colony, not a shop name. These aren't branded kirana tie-ups (no 'Sorvet at Ratnadeep'-style placement) — they're effectively private homes or small freezer drops inside local general stores. That makes the network genuinely hard to locate and impossible to brand at the point of sale.

C. Q-Commerce Absence • D. Packaging & Content Gap

C. Digital / Q-Commerce Absence

Zero visible Blinkit, Zepto, or Swiggy Instamart listing. Gen Z's impulse ice-cream decision has migrated to Q-commerce — HUL already captures 10%+ of its ice cream revenue through this channel. Sorvet is invisible in the exact moment the impulse decision gets made.

D. Packaging & Social Content Gap

Gen Z buys ice cream partly for the content opportunity — product unboxing, first-bite videos, and aesthetically distinctive packaging drive organic reach. Sorvet's Luxury Stick format is naturally more photogenic than a standard scoop, but there is no campaign, creator brief, or hashtag turning that into free reach.

Format and Flavour Alignment

- Impulse format (cones, sticks) leads at 60.6% of India's ice cream market by volume — Sorvet's format is exactly where the volume is.
- Salted Caramel and Tiramisu are genuine Gen Z flavour-trend signals, and both are already in Sorvet's range.
- Matcha correction: matcha is a real market trend, but it is not currently a Sorvet flavour — worth flagging as potential white space, not an existing strength.

OPEN QUESTION

Does this segment want these flavours pre-packed, or scooped fresh onto a cone in front of them? The base report doesn't resolve this — it's a real fork for whatever comes next.

Milano — Benchmark, Not Direct Competitor

Milano is the most instructive comparison because it shows what success looks like when premium positioning and Gen Z social strategy combine — but destination dessert and kirana impulse are different purchase occasions. Sorvet shouldn't try to become Milano; the real fight is elsewhere.

Creates Viral Moments Intentionally

The flower gelato is designed to be photographed first, tasted second.

Location as Marketing

Jubilee Hills is where Hyderabad's Gen Z social scene already plays out.

Emotional Range Across the Menu

Alcohol flavours for novelty-seekers, KitKat/Oreo for comfort-seekers, Italian originals for authenticity-seekers.

The Real Shelf Fight

Sorvet LOSES on

- Brand recognition — Walls & Amul are household names
- Distribution depth — Walls' near-universal cold chain
- Swiggy/Blinkit impulse-buying channel

Sorvet WINS on

- Flavour range complexity & international coding (Belgium, Madagascar, Swiss)
- Premium format — Luxury Stick looks and sounds superior to a standard cornetto

This is currently a brand-awareness war, and Sorvet is showing up unnamed — no in-store signage, no branded freezer, no story justifying a ₹40 premium over Walls.